

Argos

Argos is the Slocum's **one-way satellite position beacon** — the backstop that lets you *find* a glider when the two-way links ([Iridium](#) and [Freewave](#)) can't be reached. The glider carries a **Seimac X-Cat PTT** (Platform Transmitter Terminal) whose 401 MHz antenna lives in the [tail fin](#) alongside the GPS/Iridium and Freewave antennas. It transmits **last-known GPS positions** and the Argos network also derives **periodic surface fixes accurate to ~100 m** from the bursts themselves.

Unlike Iridium, Argos is **transmit-only**: you cannot command the glider over it, and you cannot send data down to it. It exists for one job — buying you a search area when everything else is silent.

Source

Paraphrased from the *Slocum G3 Glider Operators Manual* (Rev. 1, "Argos Satellite Platform Transmitter Terminal", "Communicating with Argos", and Appendix H), the *Slocum G3 Maintenance Manual*, the UG2 community Slack, and the Teledyne Webb Research user forum. This is a condensed field reference — always defer to the official Teledyne documentation, and contact glidersupport@teledyne.com (and **Service Argos**) before changing any Argos configuration.

How Argos is activated

This is the question that trips people up: **Argos transmits only while the glider is powered up at the surface — never underwater**. 401 MHz radio doesn't propagate through seawater, so there is nothing to gain (and nothing emitted) while diving. The PTT keys up only when the glider is sitting on top with its antenna in the air.

Behaviour is set by a single sensor, `c_argos_on` :